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Chris Dahlitz
[redacted]

2025 Federal Election Review

Personal submission by Mr Chris Dahlitz

1.0 INTRODUCTION

My name is Chris Dahlitz and I am a member of the Labor Party. I was the endorsed Labor candidate for the NSW State seat of Cootamundra at the 2023 State Election.

Whilst only a short time member of the NSW Labor Party, I have a long-term interest in politics and was involved with the Union movement for most of my working life as a public servant in the NSW Electricity Supply Industry.

2.0 ELECTION MATERIALS – CORFLUTES ON TREES.

I made the decision in the 2023 State Election (with the support of local members) NOT to put corflutes on Trees – and even put out a Press Release to that effect. The Labor Candidate for Farrer in 2025 adopted the same position.

In the recent Federal Election, Corflutes for Liberal and the Independent candidate were observed nailed or screwed onto living trees – see photos below:

CONCLUSION –Electoral Laws should be changed to PROHIBIT the attachment of election material to trees (living or dead). All election materials (including corflutes) should be 'environmentally friendly'. (recyclable or bio-degradable).

3.0 ELECTION MATERIALS – CORFLUTES AT PRIVATE HOMES.

Some members of the Labor Party were not comfortable to put Corflutes in their front yards – as they would be 'labelled' as Labor people in their small communities. Some of our members who were in rented accommodation were happy to display a corflute – but their Landlord made them remove it.

4.0 VERBAL ABUSE OF VOLUNTEERS AT POLLING BOOTHS

During the 2023 State Election this occurred for my Volunteers (including my wife who is NOT a Party Member). Because of the 'targeting' of my wife in 2023, I chose NOT to be involved in distributing electoral material for the 2025 Federal Election.

However, reports from various polling booths across Farrer in the 2025 Federal Election was that similar incidents occurred again, not necessarily directed at Labor, and in at least one instance, a Labor volunteer intervened in an argument involving other groups.

Thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the 2025 Election Review.

Christopher Dahlitz